

AARON FOOTE

aafoote31@gmail.com ◊  ◊  ◊  ◊ 914-523-2738

EDUCATION

Wesleyan University, Middletown, CT

M.A. in Computer Science

B.A. with High Honors in Computer Science, Minor in Data Analysis

September 2020 - May 2025

GPA: 4.22/4.00

GPA: 3.87/4.00

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Associate

CMC Foundation for Change

June 2025 - Present

Palo Alto, CA

- Coordinate survey data collection with clinicians and community leaders
- Overhauling database with hundreds of surveys on substance abuse treatment trainings with Python and SPSS
- Developing data visualizations and reports for internal decisions and external fundraising/presentation
- Mentor small team of research assistants on data cleaning, data management, data analysis, and report writing processes

Data Engineer Intern

Climecard

June 2025 - August 2025

Palo Alto, CA

- Constructed SQLite database and RESTful APIs serving 100K+ properties nationwide for climate compliance tracking
- Leveraged AI to extract and synthesize previously inaccessible data from PDFs
- Built user-friendly emissions and energy dashboards for REIT client with \$10 billion in assets

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant – Interpretable ML

Wesleyan University

June 2024 - August 2025

Middletown, CT

- Developed a hypothesis test under minimal assumptions to evaluate feature importance methods for bias
- Validated the method through extensive simulation and application to real datasets in Python and R
- Integrated dimension reduction techniques to extend the test to higher dimension

Research Assistant – Sports Analytics

Wesleyan University

January 2024 - June 2024

Middletown, CT

- Produced an intuitive evaluation tool for NFL defenders using spatiotemporal player tracking data
- Leveraged ensemble ML algorithms to estimate player value and assign credit to defenders
- Designed and deployed an NCAA March Madness prediction model using Cox proportional hazards and bootstrapping
- Explored time-varying Cox model and random/deterministic bracket completion through extensive simulation

Research Assistant – Algorithms, Computational Complexity

Wesleyan University

September 2022 - May 2025

Middletown, CT

- Established complexity results and phase transition behavior for the solving of combinatorial puzzles
- Developed high-performance solvers in C/bash on HPC cluster
- Built web scraping pipeline and analyzed 25K+ puzzles published online with Python to identify difficulty heuristics

Summer Research Fellow – Computer Vision, Natural Language Processing

Wesleyan University

June 2021 - September 2021

Middletown, CT

- Developed a pipeline to extract text from political ads using corner detection and OCR, reducing costs by 100x
- Automated the workflow and post-processing with adaptive string clustering for over 200K ads

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Substitute Teacher/Paraeducator

Swing Education

September 2025 - Present

Palo Alto, CA

- Foster a positive and inclusive learning environment that supports diverse student needs
- Deliver engaging lessons across multiple grade levels and subject areas
- Manage classroom behavior effectively by applying school policies

Head Quantitative Analysis Tutor

Wesleyan University

April 2023 - May 2025

Middletown, CT

- Held 10+ hours of weekly office hours open to the entire university, assisting with coursework, projects and research
- Provided one-on-one statistical consulting for undergraduate and graduate thesis projects
- Guided students in managing and analyzing data, employing and interpreting statistical techniques, and visualizing their work with R, STATA, Python, SPSS, SAS, and Excel
- Developed a schedule each semester, lead weekly meetings, and consult with professors

Teaching Assistant

Wesleyan University

September 2022 - December 2024

Middletown, CT

- Led weekly lab sections for 15+ students, explaining complex concepts through hands-on activities
- Graded 50+ assignments weekly on Moodle, providing detailed feedback to improve student understanding
- Courses: Algorithms, Theory of Computation, Survival Analysis, Applied Data Analysis

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS

Foote, A. and Krizanc, D. (2025) "Nonogram: Complexity of Inference and Phase Transition Behavior." *arXiv Pre-Print* doi:10.48550/arXiv.2507.07283

Foote, A. and Krizanc, D. (2025) "TRIP: A Nonparametric Test to Diagnose Biased Feature Importance Scores." *IJCAI Workshop on Explainable Artificial Intelligence* (Oral Presentation) doi:10.48550/arXiv.2507.07276

Foote, A. and Matthews, G. (2024). "Continuous Within-Play Estimation of Run-Stopping Contribution in American Football." *Cascadia Symposium on Statistics in Sports* (Poster).

Foote, A., Gooyabadi, M. and Addleman, N. (2023). "Factors in Learning Dynamics Influencing Relative Strengths of Strategies in Poker Simulation." *Games*. doi:10.3390/g14060073.

Foote, A., Oleinikov, P. (2021). "Efficiently Extracting Text from Political Ad Videos." *CIS Summer Research Symposium*. (Poster)

AWARDS

Maureen Snow Prize (July 2023): Runner-up among 200 students, given for most effective communication of research to a broad audience

Baker '64 Collabria Fellowship in Data Analysis (April 2023) – \$5,000

Best Data Story Award (April 2023): Awarded at Northeast Division ASA DataFest Competition

QAC Apprentice Grant (April 2021) – \$5,400

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Tools and Languages: R, Python (NumPy, Pandas, TensorFlow, matplotlib, scikit-learn), SPSS, STATA, SAS, Excel, SQL, C, Typescript

Methods: neural networks, statistical learning, linear regression, data visualization, exploratory data analysis, hypothesis testing, time series, survival analysis, data engineering, categorical data analysis, qualitative data analysis